

M Tabarik Asif

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity engineer specializing in application security, API security, and fintech infrastructure protection. Experienced in identifying critical vulnerabilities (IDOR, LFI, financial data exposures) in production systems handling high-value financial transactions and large user bases. Proven ability to lead security teams, implement SIEM and DLP solutions, and drive secure SDLC practices. Bug Bounty Hall of Fame recipient from Coca-Cola and Tecno (Bugcrowd/HackerOne). OSCP candidate.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Sr. Security Engineer | DigiKhata — Fintech Security Engineering & Leadership Jan 2025 – Present

- Led end-to-end security operations for a fintech platform handling high-volume financial transactions across mobile, web, API, cloud, and infrastructure
- Managed and mentored a team of 4 security professionals across task delegation, security reviews, and skill development
- Deployed and operationalized Wazuh SIEM for continuous threat detection across Linux and Windows server infrastructure
- Implemented DLP controls to prevent unauthorized exfiltration of sensitive financial and PII data
- Designed DDoS prevention strategies, API security hardening, and a formal vulnerability management program
- Identified and remediated 15+ critical vulnerabilities including IDOR, LFI, and financial/PII data exposures across production systems
- Enforced ISO 27001 compliance through continuous risk assessments and security policy implementation

Security Specialist | DigiKhata — Fintech Application Security Jun 2024 – Jan 2025

- Identified critical vulnerabilities including IDOR, LFI, and PII/financial data exposures across 5+ production Android, iOS, Flutter, and web applications
- Assessed APIs, databases, and network infrastructure — ensured timely remediation and least privilege enforcement
- Implemented encryption, secure authentication, and DevSecOps practices across the software development lifecycle
- Managed vulnerability tracking, reporting, and coordinated remediation with engineering teams

Independent Security Researcher | Bugcrowd & HackerOne — Bug Bounty 2020 – 2024

- Resolved P1 authentication bypass on Coca-Cola and XSS vulnerability on Tecno, earning Hall of Fame recognition on Bugcrowd and HackerOne
- Discovered and reported high-impact vulnerabilities including SQLi, XSS, IDOR, Broken Authentication, and sensitive data exposures across multiple bug bounty programs
- Collaborated with security teams to ensure professional, timely vulnerability disclosure and remediation

PROJECTS

HissabAI | Founder & Director — AI-Powered Personal Finance 2024 – Present

- Founded and architected a WhatsApp-based AI personal finance tracker for the Pakistani market, built on Node.js, Next.js, PostgreSQL, Redis, and AWS infrastructure, hissabai.com
- Designed and implemented full security stack including AWS KMS encryption, Secrets Manager credential management, API security hardening, and secure authentication on production EC2 infrastructure
- Integrated Meta WhatsApp Cloud API and Claude AI engine, managing end-to-end security of financial data flows and user PII

Other Notable Projects

- **Web Vulnerability Scanner** — Final year project scanning web applications for OWASP Top 10 vulnerabilities

- **AWS WAF Deployment** — Designed and implemented AWS WAF with ACLs, bot control integrations, and IP Sets for production traffic filtering
- Home Lab — **Active Directory simulation environment** with 10+ monitoring and security tools for hands-on research
- **Automation** — Automated reconnaissance pipelines, Nuclei templates, and Bash scripts for security workflows
- **CTF & Hackathons** — Active participant in cybersecurity CTF competitions and hackathons

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Application Security: IDOR, XSS, LFI, SQLi, Broken Authentication, API security testing, OWASP Top 10

Penetration Testing: Web, Mobile (Android/iOS/Flutter), API — Burp Suite Pro, Nmap, Nikto, Metasploit, SQLMap, Nuclei

Cloud Security: AWS (KMS, WAF, IAM, Secrets Manager, S3, EC2), cloud infrastructure hardening

SIEM & Monitoring: Wazuh, Splunk (SPL, detection rules), DLP solutions, GoPhish

Infrastructure Security: Linux server hardening, network segmentation, OPNsense, UniFi, firewall configuration

Scripting & Development: Python, Bash, PowerShell, Go (basic)

Frameworks & Standards: ISO 27001, OWASP Top 10, DevSecOps, PECA 2016

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Computer Science | [Hazara University](#) 2020 – 2024

Key Courses: Operating Systems, Computer Networks, Information Security, Web Engineering, Python, Databases

Certifications & Professional Development

- Offensive Security Certified Professional (OSCP) — In Preparation
- CompTIA Security+ — Self-Study, 2024
- IBM Cybersecurity Analyst Professional Certificate — IBM Technologies, 2023
- Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate — Google, 2023
- Business English Communication Specialization — University of Washington, 2024

ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- Bug Bounty Hall of Fame — Coca-Cola (P1 Authentication Bypass) and Tecno (XSS), Bugcrowd Submission Shogun L3
- President, Society of Computer Technology — Organized 10+ departmental activities, 3 workshops, and 2 HEC-recognized project exhibitions
- Township Welfare Foundation — Executive committee member overseeing 4 active community projects
- Blood Donation Camps — Organized 3 on-campus drives collecting 150+ units of blood
- Computer Technology Performance Award — Received for outstanding academic and technical contributions